

Saint Cyril of Alexandria
Second Oration to the Queens

I. To those who administer that divine and heavenly office of preaching, God, the Creator of all, through the voice of the prophet Isaiah, thus commands: "Ascend a high mountain, you who bring good news to Zion; lift up your voice with strength, you who bring good news to Jerusalem; lift it up, do not be afraid" (Isaiah 40:9). Indeed, those who are called to the order of priests have been assigned the province of expounding the mysteries of Christ, our Savior, to the people, and they must not allow themselves to be cast down in spirit, nor to be overcome by sloth or broken by fear; rather, they should walk with dignity, as if they were placed upon a mountain. It is fitting that, in this manner, they should seek out and delve into the exquisite beauty of true doctrines and be able to speak boldly, even if some among those who are informed by the sacred teachings present themselves as stubborn and unmanageable, like horses that cannot be restrained. Concerning these, blessed David, interceding with the supreme Creator of all things, writes: "With bit and bridle, restrain their jaws, for they do not come near you" (Psalm 32:9). If, with such a mindset, it is necessary to exert force, how absurd would it be for you to remain silent, unwilling to pour forth the knowledge of the sacred Scriptures into your pious ears, as if it were a sweet and life-giving stream? Indeed, God once spoke through the voice of the prophet Isaiah, promising us with these words: "You will draw water with joy from the wells of salvation" (Isaiah 12:3). We call the wells of salvation the holy prophets, evangelists, and apostles; for these, imbued with heavenly doctrine, irrigate this world and bring joy to the entire earth through the Holy Spirit. Therefore, fixing our eyes on the profound meanings, let us draw forth the discovery of truth from there. Just as farmers, at the appropriate time, gather the most fragrant flowers from the fields and present them, arranged skillfully in baskets, to their masters, who embrace them with benevolence and are marvelously affected by their beauty and charm, so we, who have taken on the duty of teaching, offer from divine Scripture, as if from a field of flowers that do not quickly wither, not the beauty of flowers, but the richness and sweetness of the words and teachings contained therein through the Holy Spirit, which soon exudes the fragrance of that piety in Christ, the imperishable beauty of the mystery. For it is written, "We are the aroma of Christ to God" (2 Corinthians 2:15).

II. Therefore, O most beloved queen of piety, I offer to you the book that I have composed on the right and blameless faith in our Lord Jesus Christ, which ought to

be yours. It is fitting for you, devoted as you are to sanctity and piety, along with the highest dignity of the kingdom, to be redeemed by the crown of charity that is in Christ. For this has already been prepared for your venerable heights, and the Lord of all glory adorns you with a glory that will never perish. Nevertheless, that you may be adorned even more, I have composed a little prayer in which I make it clear that just as there is one Father, from whom all things come, so also our Lord Jesus Christ, through whom all things exist, is one; there is indeed one Holy Spirit, in whom all things are. However, those who divide the one Christ, Lord, and Son into two sons, we, having been rightly taught, will not support at all. For we do not say that there is another Son who was begotten from the substance of God the Father before all ages, and another who was born of a woman in the last times and became subject to the law; but we affirm the same one both before that true conjunction of the Word with human flesh and after it. For the Son, who proceeds naturally from God the Father, was born according to the flesh from the God-bearing Virgin Mary, yet he did not in any way turn into flesh; may that never be. Indeed, he assumed it in such a way that he did not in any part harm his divinity; for he remained, even in this way, the Lord of all.

III. And indeed, we have been taught to feel this. Since the sermons of the holy Fathers and their wise admonitions urge us to diligently observe with great care what is most in accordance with divine Scripture, and with subtle understanding to apply ourselves to those things that have been expounded concerning Christ, we should contemplate the truth of divine dogmas: demolishing arguments and every lofty thing that raises itself against the knowledge of God, and taking every thought captive to the obedience of him. For when all agree in one accord that the natural Word of God the Father, which exists in the form and equality of the same God, did not consider it robbery to be equal with God; but, having taken the form of a servant, emptied himself, and was made in the likeness of men, and found in human form, humbled himself, and became obedient to death, even the death of the cross, it is absolutely necessary for anyone who wishes to rightly discern the force of those things written about Christ to have a heart instructed with the best sentiments; so that he may be able to perceive how God and man are the same Christ, and how God remains without any alteration or change (for the nature of the Word is immutable), and does not reject the humility of his emptying: for he who willingly endured humiliation for our sake in a dispensational manner does not blush at his own counsel. Therefore, he ought to be seen as conspicuous in the

majesty of divinity, and yet not to be considered entirely alien from our condition of humility, on account of the humanity he has assumed; for this is what the nature of the dispensation requires. If indeed the Word of God became flesh, that is, man, according to that which is said: I will pour out my Spirit upon all flesh; no one should justly be disturbed if divine Scriptures reveal him in ways that are never humble, such as are fitting for men. Rather, let one behold his heavenly glory and majesty from his divine and supreme virtue and excellence.

IV. Therefore, I will endeavor to explain those matters which seem to disturb the minds of the simpler souls more than others, as clearly as possible, using the greatest clarity that can be achieved, with a suitable solution provided for each opinion, while God himself guides our path even in this endeavor. For he gives the word to those who proclaim the Gospel with great power, as the divine Psalmist sings. Moreover, in that commentary which we have composed for the sacred virgins, we have abundantly expounded those things which appeared more obvious and easier to understand; in this present work, however, we shall engage in the explanation of more obscure matters. It is fitting that your religious majesty should know both this and that, so that through both, perfect knowledge may dwell like a certain light in your most holy minds. It has been proposed to interpret each point in such a way that we pursue brevity everywhere. Furthermore, I wish to begin this discussion particularly with those matters that pertain to the humiliation of the Word; let it be noted in advance that when Jesus Christ is named, it refers to no other than the incarnate Word of God the Father, made man, designated by that name.

V. I want you to know that the head of every man is Christ; the head of a woman is man; but the head of Christ is God. The first man (that is, Adam) was from the earth, earthly; the second man (that is, Christ) is from heaven, heavenly. Therefore, just as we have borne the image of the earthly, let us also bear the image of the heavenly, as it is written. Thus, the head of our race, that is, the origin, Adam, was from the earth, earthly; but since Christ has taken on the title of the second Adam, he has been established as the head, that is, the origin, of those who are being transformed by the Spirit of sanctification into incorruption according to his image. Therefore, he is our principle, that is, head, inasmuch as he appeared as a man; yet he also has a head, since by nature he is God, namely, the heavenly Father. From him, indeed, the Word, being God, is naturally begotten. The fact that the head is the same as the origin, or that this one can calm the fluctuating

souls, is because man is said to be the head of the woman; for she was taken from him. Therefore, there is one Christ, one Son, and one Lord; who, as God by nature, has the Father as his head, who is in heaven; but he has become our head because of the kinship of the flesh he assumed.

VI. For you know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that though he was rich, yet for your sake he became poor, so that by his poverty you might become rich. Observe here clearly the excellence of the divine and immortal nature, and the humble condition of human nature, as well as the union of both, since the Only Begotten willingly descended to this state. For just as the riches of divinity far surpass all the power and abundance of prayer, so human nature is exceedingly poor and destitute; indeed, everything it possesses, whatever good it has, is bestowed from heaven by God: and above all, that very existence by which it exists; for when it once was not, it was called into existence by God. Therefore, he who was rich as God became voluntarily poor and became like us, so that human nature in him, elevated to the height of divine excellence, might cast off the confusion of poverty. For he has raised us up together and made us sit in the heavenly places in Christ Jesus, as it is written. Yet we would not have been elevated here unless he, rich as God, had clothed our poor and destitute nature. Nor is it right to say that man, by his own nature, is poor; rather, it is fittingly asserted that this has come to him who, without any controversy, is rich, that is, the Word of God the Father, after he became like us. Therefore, there is one Christ and one Son.

VII. Christ redeemed us from the curse of the law, having become a curse for us; for it is written, "Cursed is everyone who hangs on a tree" (Galatians 3:13). The law declared those who fell into sin or transgression to be subject to a curse. However, Christ, who was without sin, accepted an unjust sentence upon himself and endured the punishment of the cross, which was due to those bound by the curse according to justice; so that he, who equaled the price for all, might suffer death for all, and might free everyone from the guilt of disobedience, redeeming the entire world with his blood. Moreover, one man could not have paid the price for the sins of all, if he had been merely a pure human. But if he is to be conceived of as God incarnate, having suffered death in his own flesh, then all of creation will be of little comparison to him; and thus, for the liberation of the human race, the death of one body would have been more than sufficient; for it was proper to the Word, which was born of God.

VIII. But we see Jesus, who was made a little lower than the angels, crowned with glory and honor because of the suffering of death, so that by the grace of God he might taste death for everyone. The Apostle Paul again recalls this concerning Christ, our Savior: "When he brings the firstborn into the world, he says, 'Let all the angels of God worship him.'" And again: "He is the radiance of the glory and the exact representation of his being, sustaining all things by his powerful word. After he had provided purification for sins, he sat down at the right hand of the Majesty in heaven; so he became as much superior to the angels as the name he has inherited is superior to theirs" (Hebrews 1:6-4). For to which of the angels did God ever say, "You are my Son; today I have become your Father?" (Hebrews 1:5). When, therefore, the Only Begotten became the firstborn and one of many brothers, he is said to be introduced into the world (for according to his own nature he existed outside all creation as God); then he is asserted to have been made a little lower than the angels, even if he has received a name more excellent than theirs. Indeed, this term "angels" carries with it the notion of ministry and implies a servile condition: they are sent to serve those who will inherit salvation. But the term "Son" denotes one who has substantial and natural existence from a brother; for we believe that he was truly and naturally begotten from the Father. But how, you ask, did he become a little lower than the angels, who is worshiped by them and sits with the Father on the throne of the kingdom? The answer is clear: for having taken on a body that could die, he humbled himself to the infirmities of human nature, and in that body he voluntarily endured death. For this death and passion, he earned the crown of supreme glory; for he, being life and incorruption, both abolished death through it and declared that corruption has no power. Therefore, when he is called Jesus and proclaimed to be lower than the angels, we do not conceive of him as merely a naked man, separate and apart; rather, we understand the Only Begotten himself as bearing the superior parts over the angels due to the order of the incarnation. For he who is said to yield to their excellence is truly recognized as having become man. The eminence of the holy angels is based on the fact that they are immune from flesh and that they are superior to death; yet the Son was subjected to both because of his voluntary humiliation. Truly, he who is said to be made a little lower than the angels because of the condition of human nature is, in the excellence of divinity, worshiped by them and sits upon the thrones of majesty, which they surround, continually extolling him with praises and calling him the Lord of virtues.

IX. Therefore, since children have shared in flesh and blood, he likewise participated in the same; that through death he might destroy him who had the power of death, that is, the devil; and might free those who, through fear of death, were all their lifetime subject to bondage. Here he calls us children, who live our lives on earth, according to that saying of the Psalmist sung in the person of God: "I said, 'You are gods, and all of you are children of the Most High'" (Psalm 82:6). As for the will of God and the gentleness naturally inherent in us, we would all be sons, nor would anyone be alienated from his familiarity and friendship; but because we voluntarily submit our minds to desires and disturbances of the body, as David testifies, we die like men, and fall like one of the princes. But how have we shared in flesh and blood? The human soul has a nature distinct from flesh, united to flesh, and indeed, through its union, it completes the animal endowed with reason, that is, man. In this way, the Word of God also was not inanimate, as some have supposed, but united to animated flesh, in a manner that human understanding cannot grasp, joining himself and being born of a woman, he communicated in flesh and blood just as we do. And thus there is only one Lord Jesus Christ. For although the Word of God took on human nature, he nevertheless remained what he was. If he abolished the power of death as life and God, it is necessary that that which bore death was his own; thus, indeed, he himself, returning from the dead to life, can be said to have removed corruption from the midst and transmitted the blessing of incorruption to our entire race. For as in Adam all die, so in Christ all shall be made alive (1 Corinthians 15:22). And again: "For as through a man came death, so through a man has come also the resurrection of the dead" (1 Corinthians 15:21). However, to trample upon death is an act that exceeds the capacity of human nature; therefore, the Word of God became like us through the union, that is, through the communication of flesh and blood, so that he became a man like us; yet he remained superior to death; for he was God in the flesh.

X. For He did not take hold of angels, but He took hold of the seed of Abraham. Therefore, He had to be made like His brothers in every respect, so that He might become a merciful and faithful high priest in the service of God, to make propitiation for the sins of the people. For because He Himself has suffered and been tempted, He is able to help those who are being tempted. We assert that the Word of God took hold of the seed of Abraham. For according to the flesh, He was born of the Jews and was made like His brothers in all things; that is, He took on

the form of a servant, as the Apostle teaches, and He did not disdain to be born in the manner of other men. For this reason, the Son of Man also came to be, and He became a brother to those who were descended from Abraham, that is, to those constituted of flesh and blood. What was the reason for this? Certainly, it was so that He might become a merciful and faithful high priest in matters pertaining to God. For Christ has shown Himself to us to be a high priest exceedingly kind and merciful. Indeed, while the letter of the law condemns sins and decrees the gravest punishment for those who have violated God's command, saying, "Anyone who violates the law of Moses dies without mercy on the evidence of two or three witnesses" (Hebrews 10:28), Christ justifies by faith and absolves those who have fallen from their former sins. Therefore, He became a merciful high priest, not allowing that legal severity to prevail any longer.

XI. The faithful high priest, since he is perpetual and steadfast, is most worthy of whose promises faith is held. However, concerning the legal priests, the matter is quite different, as the Apostle testifies. For he says, "And there were many priests, because they were prevented by death from continuing; but he, because he remains forever, has a priesthood that is unchangeable." Hence, he is able to save those who draw near to God through him, since he always lives to intercede for them. Observe here how he became a high priest not for the condemnation of those who were bound by their sins, but rather for the purification and propitiation of their offenses. But what kind of mode, I ask, was there both in his temptation and in that sacrifice? For he says, "In that he himself has suffered and been tempted, he is able to aid those who are tempted." Indeed, he was tempted and patiently endured the punishment of the cross. Moreover, the Son offered himself as an unblemished sacrifice to God the Father; namely, that through his own flesh, he might provide help to those who struggle with troubles and temptations. For by one offering he has perfected forever those who are sanctified. Therefore, he was made a high priest according to human nature, although, as God, he is to be sacrificed by all. He is the one who, according to the flesh, became the victim. He is the same again, who, according to the authority of divinity, is merciful and gracious concerning our sins. Therefore, there is one Lord Jesus Christ.

XII. You worship what you do not know; we worship what we know; for salvation is from the Jews (John 4:22). Perhaps someone might object here that it is not fitting to worship one in that supreme and divine nature of the Word. If, therefore, Christ is true God, how does he count himself among those who ought to be

worshiped? What, I ask, shall we respond to this? For if we believe that the Word of God the Father appeared in the world with nothing but divine nature, it would not be fitting to worship him alone. For he is truly worshiped more than any other being. But if he took on the form of a servant, not rejecting the humility and conditions of the nature of the worshiper, he became the Son of Man; then indeed worship would align with the order of the dispensation and the condition of his humiliation, but not with the nature of the Word considered in itself. For unless this is established, how can it be understood that salvation is from the Jews? Nor is it permissible to say that the Word, as it is considered in itself, is from the Jews; rather, he is from them in that he became a brother of those who are made of flesh and blood, being joined to the seed of Abraham. Therefore, there is one Christ, who indeed worships as a man; but as God, he is worshiped by all creation.

XIII. Yet a little while I am with you. I go to him who sent me. If the nature of divinity fills all things, where, I ask, does the Word of God not exist? By what reason, then, is he sent by the Father? Or in what manner does he return to him? He is sent according to human nature, to proclaim release to the captives and recovery of sight to the blind; for this is the reason and manner of that mission. But he also goes to God the Father; however, not in exactly the same way. He goes, as it were, in the body returning to heaven, so that he may appear before the paternal face for us, as it is written. If anyone takes the term "mission" to refer to the Word itself, let no one be troubled by this; for it is the custom of divinely inspired Scriptures to sometimes use such expressions, not because it wishes to circumscribe or define that divine and heavenly nature (for it knows that it is free from the body and superior to every term and place), but because it seeks to manifest to us those things which otherwise exceed the grasp of our minds through human words. For the Savior himself also promises that he will send the Paraclete to us, even though the Holy Spirit fills all things, according to the saying: The Spirit of the Lord has filled the world.

XIV. When you have exalted the Son of Man, then you will know that I am. Explaining the causes of the Jewish madness, which was directed against Christ, blessed John writes: Therefore the Jews persecuted Jesus, because he not only broke the Sabbath, but also called God his Father, making himself equal to God. Elsewhere, he introduces them, uttering these impious words: "We do not stone you for a good work, but for blasphemy; because you, being a man, make yourself God." Therefore, they were unwilling to believe in him for any reason, since they

thought he was merely an ordinary man, unaware that the Word of God had taken hold of the seed of Abraham and had shared in flesh and blood just like us, although for this reason he did not cease to be God; for according to his nature, he is unchangeable and the same forever. He says therefore: When you have exalted the Son of Man, then you will know that I am. For although he suffered the punishment of the cross according to human nature, he rose again by divine power. Because of the resurrection, he is believed to be both true God and truly the Son of God. If we believe that he did not raise another but rose himself, we must certainly affirm that the body which suffered death was his own, as it was given to him for the purpose of salvation; for this reason, he can also say that he rose again, although by his very nature he is immortal as God. For by announcing the death and resurrection of the one and the same Christ and Son, we are justified by faith. Therefore, Christ Jesus is one and the same, who died as a man according to the flesh; but as God and life, he is said to have risen.

XV. Therefore, the Jews surrounded him and said to him, "How long will you keep us in suspense? If you are the Christ, tell us plainly." Jesus answered them, "I told you, and you do not believe. The works that I do in my Father's name bear witness about me" (John 10:25). What, I ask, do they say, who foolishly tear apart our one Lord Jesus Christ into two sons, and thus into two Christs? About whom were the Jews saying, "If you are the Christ, tell us plainly"? Which of them was preaching again: "The works that I do in my Father's name bear witness about me"? Which Father of God shall we establish, the one who is born of a woman, as if conceived separately by himself, or truly the Only-Begotten himself? But indeed, to perform divine works is something that far surpasses the powers and capabilities of human nature. Therefore, since Christ performed the same works as the Father, he was certainly not merely a man, but God clothed in flesh and blood, so that he might truly remain what he was. In this way, he will accomplish things equal to his Creator; thus, the reasoning of this mystery, when explained, is free from reproach among those of sound mind.

XVI. The child, however, grew and became strong in spirit, filled with wisdom; and the grace of God was upon him; and further, Jesus increased in wisdom and stature, and in favor with God and men (Luke 2:40, 52). Affirming that our Lord Jesus Christ is entirely one, we assert that he equally possesses both human and divine attributes. Indeed, we maintain that the true nature of his humiliation corresponds to the reception of bodily growth, as well as the gradual consolidation

and confirmation of bodily parts; and this very aspect seemed to be fulfilled in wisdom, since along with the growth of the body, wisdom was increasingly manifesting itself outwardly. And this, as I have said, was fitting for the dispensation of the flesh and the condition of humiliation. However, to obtain a perpetual and constant perfection, as well as to possess wisdom, aligns with the nature of the Word himself. Therefore, both those aspects that pertain to his humiliation and those that pertain to the excellence of the divine nature belong to him. For the manner and method of his dispensation with the flesh recognizes him as both similar to us and, in some respects, superior to us. Just as he excels all creation in many ways as God, so too, as man, he exists in a certain way as lesser than himself. For what purpose is humiliation, into which he willingly descended, if he does not acknowledge what is proper to human nature? Yet, the nature of the Word is not recognized in these things; rather, he assumed all such experiences along with his own flesh, such as hunger, thirst, and the weariness of travel. Therefore, when it is said, "The child grew and became strong in spirit, filled with wisdom," let this be understood as the mystery of the dispensation with the flesh taking on the cause of advocacy. The fact that God was in the flesh is confirmed by the evangelist in this way: "For the grace of God was upon him." For he is not said to have the grace of God as if he had borrowed it from another God, but because, while he was a child, he was adorned with such grace as befitted God; since he was the Word of God, and is, even if he appeared in the flesh and became like us. Therefore, nothing absurd or contrary to reason is asserted if it is said that he also has grace, that is, that he increased in grace with God and men; for the Father regarded both the dispensation of the flesh and the Son himself, who assumed what is proper to the flesh, as beneficial for the mystery and fitting for himself.

XVII. Concerning that day and hour, no one knows, neither the angels of heaven nor the Son, but only the Father. If they object that Christ, who is the Word of God incarnate, that is, made man, certainly knows the day of consummation, how is it that he is said to be ignorant of it? We respond that the ignorance of divine secrets is neither disgraceful to the creature nor unusual for him. For it is written: Who has known the mind of the Lord? Therefore, if the Son, inasmuch as he became man, is said to be made a little lower than the angels (for as God, he sustains the entire creation), what is so surprising if he is reported to be ignorant of God's secrets just as the angels are, even though he is the wisdom and power of God the Father? Indeed, the wisdom of God the Father cannot be ignorant of those things which lie

hidden in him. For if the Spirit searches all things, even the deep things of God, and that Spirit is the Spirit of Christ, how could he be unaware of what that Spirit perfectly knows? Thus, although he may be said to be ignorant as a man, as God, he knows all things. Therefore, even if as a man he bore ignorance when he asked about Lazarus, Where have you laid him? he nonetheless openly declares himself to be God when he raises him from the dead with powerful virtue. Therefore, while we attribute to the dispensation of the incarnation those things which belong to man, we also preserve those things which are fitting for the Son of God, which are appropriate for him as God, who became man like us, from the Word of God begotten, which are suitable for him as God.

XVIII. Jesus cried out with a loud voice, saying: My God, my God, why have you forsaken me? Shall we say that the Word, which was born of God the Father, needed divine assistance? But what could be more foolish than this? Is he not the Lord of all creation along with God the Father, who strengthens heaven with his Spirit, and is he not called the Lord of hosts, and is this not truly so? Did he then succumb to the plots of the Jews? Could he not overcome the hands of those who crucified him? Yet the prophet Isaiah says: If all the nations are regarded as a drop from a bucket, and are counted as the small dust of the balance, and are considered as nothing: to whom then will you liken God? Or what likeness will you compare to him? It is important to remember here that the ministers of the Jewish Synagogue rushed upon Jesus with a cohort of soldiers, led by a traitor, in order to seize him. When they came seeking him, he met them, saying: Whom do you seek? They answered him: Jesus of Nazareth. Jesus said to them: I am he. And they went backward and fell to the ground. Now how can he be called weak, who even by the mere voice of those insulting him showed his own strength? What then does he mean when he says, My God, my God, why have you forsaken me? Therefore, we say that when our first parent Adam trampled upon the command he had received and neglected the divine law, human nature was in a certain way forsaken, made accursed and subject to death. But as soon as the Only Begotten of God came to restore what had fallen into corruption, having taken hold of the seed of Abraham, he was made like his brothers; then, along with that ancient curse and the introduced corruption, it was necessary for the forsakenness that human nature had experienced at its beginning to be put to rest. Thus, as one of the forsaken, in that he himself was also a partaker of flesh and blood, he said: Why have you forsaken me? This voice was indeed one that overturned that forsakenness which

had befallen us, and it was a plea to the Father, reflecting the dignity of the speaker, and also a provocation to goodwill towards us as towards himself and the firstborn; since Christ has been the giver and author of all good things to us. Hence, even if something is said to have been received from the Father as a man, he bestowed all of this upon our nature; for as God, being full, he has no need of any good thing at all.

XIX. For this is the mind that you should have among yourselves, which is also in Christ Jesus: who, though he was in the form of God, did not consider equality with God something to be grasped, but emptied himself, taking the form of a servant, being made in the likeness of men, and being found in appearance as a man. He humbled himself, becoming obedient to the point of death, even death on a cross. Therefore God also highly exalted him and bestowed on him the name that is above every name, so that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, of those in heaven, on earth, and under the earth; and every tongue should confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father. Here it is clearly explained that the Word of God, who was in the form and equality of God the Father, did not consider it robbery to be equal with God; but, having taken on the form of a servant, he voluntarily emptied himself and took on the likeness of men. It is also added that he humbled himself and rendered obedience even to death, and that death on a cross. If, therefore, one and only Christ and Lord must be divided into two Christs and sons, as some would have it, and the Word of God is understood to have been born of a woman with the same majesty and equality, and according to the reason of authority and communion of sonship, he added to himself as if he were another, that is, distinct from himself, who then is the one who emptied himself; or by what reasoning did he undergo this emptying? For if, as they assert, he is a pure man who is understood to have come forth from a woman, having suffered this, how, or by what reasoning, was he cast down into emptiness? For how can he be said to have descended into humility, who is so joined in fellowship and affinity with the Word of God that he is considered to have equal dignity and authority with him? If that emptying is proclaimed of the Word of God as understood separately and by itself, how can he be said to have emptied himself, who, as they say, honors another and adorns him with his own titles and dignities? How can he be said to be humbled, who has conferred the height of his own glory upon another associated with him? For if they assert that he is humbled or emptied because another is honored, it would certainly not be absurd to also understand that

he who inflicts injury is exalted. Therefore, a true and necessary reason compels, and almost forces, us to believe that he himself, having undergone the fullness of emptying, did not, by his own nature, become a servant, but rather, having taken on the form of a servant, he clothed himself in it; and in the likeness of men he became one who was not such by nature before he became man, and finally we must consider and proclaim that he humbled himself from the very height of his own nature. Therefore, we believe that the Word of God voluntarily lowered himself according to human nature for our sake, while remaining in the summit of his own excellence according to divine nature. For this reason, he is said to be superexalted, and to have received a name that is above every name, and to be adored by all, and to be called Lord to the glory of God the Father. For even if he were established in the eminence and incomprehensible majesty of the Father, yet when he humbled himself, he took on the form of a servant, and again, transcending the poverty of the nature united to him, that is, human, he ascended to his own riches: for this reason, he is said to have received according to human nature that which he possesses perpetually and steadfastly in himself, namely, to be God and Lord of all. Finally, if it is honorable for the Father to have a Son who holds dominion over all and everything, who can doubt that even after having accepted the form of a servant, his freedom and the integrity of supernatural power and dominion over all is preserved?

XX. Giving thanks to the Father, who made us worthy to share in the inheritance of the saints in light; who rescued us from the power of darkness and transferred us into the kingdom of his beloved Son; in whom we have redemption and the forgiveness of sins; who is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn of all creation; for in him all things were created in heaven and on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or dominions or principalities or powers, all things were created through him and for him; and he is before all things, and in him all things hold together. And he is the head of the body, the Church, who is the beginning, the firstborn from the dead, that in everything he might be preeminent; for in him all the fullness was pleased to dwell, and through him to reconcile to himself all things, whether on earth or in heaven, making peace by the blood of his cross (Colossians 1:12-20). Here it is taught that the Word of God, that is, the Son naturally born from him, is the image of the invisible God; moreover, that all visible and invisible things, whether in heaven or on earth, were created through him; furthermore, that he precedes all things (John 1:1), and is the creator of the

ages; finally, that he has existence older than all time. Such goods, according to his own nature, are affirmed to be accumulated, the firstborn from the dead, and the head of the body of the Church given by God the Father. Now, how is it that he, who is the Word of God the Father and has always been, through whom all things hold together, is called the firstborn from the dead, if the body which he assumed was not truly his own, by which, indeed, it is understood that he underwent death? For it is not said without just cause that what happened to the body, which suffered and was his own, happened to him. Therefore, in this way, even if according to nature he is immortal and life exists by essence, he is known to be the firstborn of the dead. When, therefore, the head of the body of the Church was given, having humbled himself for our sake, he is said to have suffered death according to human nature, who, as God, was altogether ignorant of death.

XXI. Furthermore, what blessed Paul asserts about the fullness dwelling in him will perhaps be objected to in this way: Behold, he indicates that a man born of a woman, Christ, has existed as another being apart from himself, in whom the Word, that is, the Spirit, and the fullness of divinity have bodily dwelt as a separate Christ from that other one. To this, we respond that Paul did not recognize two Christs, but announced one; just as he also proclaimed one Father: "For us," he says, "there is one God the Father, from whom are all things, and we for him; and one Lord Jesus Christ, through whom are all things, and we through him" (1 Corinthians 8:6). But let us weigh the force of the words proposed here with careful consideration. He proclaims the eternal Son, in whom are all things and through whom are all things, the image of the invisible God, the creator of all things, and the firstborn from the dead, given as the head of the Church. Therefore, since the Word of God is by its very nature free from death, we cannot assert that it was not truly and perfectly united with human nature; thus, we cannot propose to ourselves one Christ, who is both God and man. But in what, then, did the fullness of all divinity dwell bodily? It would indeed be utterly absurd to suppose that this occurred in the nature of the Word considered separately by itself; for it would be the same as saying that the Only-Begotten dwelt in himself. Therefore, we piously and rightly affirm that the Word dwelt in us not through any transformation or change of itself, but through the true union of its own temple, that is, the perfect human body and soul, while that great Paul writes that all the fullness of divinity dwelt in him, not indeed through participation, or relation, or communication of grace, but bodily, that is, essentially, intending by that indwelling nothing other

than the true and natural union of the Word with the sacred flesh. Just as the spirit of a man may be said to dwell in him, yet it is not judged to be another or different from him. It happens that, in the scheme of speech, the account of one person sometimes offers us the reasoning of two persons, and yet no truth is harmed in any way: for example, when divine Scripture proclaims about God: "Who forms the spirit of man within him" (Zechariah 12:1); yet it is clear to all that the spirit of man formed within him is not another being from the man himself. This also points to what blessed David said: "I was exercising my heart by night, and my spirit was earnestly seeking" (Psalm 77:6). Who, I ask, was it that was exercising with his own heart and had his own grieving spirit? Therefore, it is necessary not to scrutinize the formulas of speech so anxiously, but rather to contemplate the very natures of things and, guided by them, to hold to the truth itself.

XXII. Therefore, just as through the disobedience of one man condemnation came upon all men, so also through the righteousness of one man justification of life came to all men. For just as through the disobedience of one man many were made sinners, so also through the obedience of one man many will be made righteous. When human nature was bound by the curse of death due to the disobedience of the first man, it was necessary for it to be restored to its original state through the demonstration of unblemished obedience. However, this exceeded the capabilities of human nature in many respects, for no one was immune from sin. For once it had fallen into error and wrongdoing, overcome by internal infirmities and lying prostrate, and having within its own flesh the root of wickedness, and carrying within its own entrails the unbridled law of sin perpetually, how could it escape from all this fall? "For the wisdom of the flesh," it is said, "is enmity against God; for it is not subject to the law of God, nor indeed can it be." Therefore, God the Father, with a marvelous dexterity, intending to restore all things through Christ and to reconcile human nature to its former state, that is, to its reintegration, sent his Son made from a woman; who, indeed, taking a body similar to ours and made his own, appeared as a man on earth, who is entirely ignorant of sin; and thus, having obeyed God the Father in all things, justified human nature in himself, freed it from the bonds of death, and was to be crowned with the robe of innocence by God the Father. Indeed, it would have been absurd for us to be constituted heirs of condemnation through the disobedience of the first Adam, which precipitated death and corruption, while remaining exempt from the justice of the latter Adam, which brings us back to life through that perfect obedience. Therefore, when

divine Scripture asserts that many are justified through the obedience of one, we ought not to think of some simple man of our condition assumed for this purpose, but of the very Only-Begotten made man, who rendered obedience to the Father for all. He is the one who, as Scripture testifies, committed no sin, nor was deceit found in his mouth.

XXIII. For I say that Christ Jesus was a minister of circumcision for the truth of God, to confirm the promises made to the fathers; but the Gentiles are to honor God for his mercy. The divine Paul proclaims that the promises made to the fathers pertain to the Jews. Yet the prophets had long ago foretold that Christ would be the expectation of the Gentiles. Therefore, our Lord Jesus Christ, conforming himself to the will of the Father, became a minister of circumcision, that is, a minister to the Jews, for the corroboration of the promises that had been made to the fathers. For it had been said, "The just shall live by faith"; but to the Gentiles, a vivifying and spiritual blessing is given, so that they, too, called through faith and having obtained mercy, may glorify God. Indeed, although he became a minister according to human nature, he is announced as God both to those who are of the circumcision and to others who are of the Gentiles. For both are called to life in Christ, not as if believing in a mere man of our kind, but as believing in God; nor do they profess the Word of God outside of the flesh, that is, outside of human nature, but they worship him incarnate, truly made man.

XXIV. The word of faith that we preach, as the Apostle says, is this: "If you confess with your mouth the Lord Jesus and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved" (Romans 10:9). Now, since God is by His very nature immortal, if we deny that He could take on a body that could die, how can we rightly say that He rose from the dead? Therefore, in the human body that He assumed, He suffered death; however, by divine power, as being life and incorruption, He rose from the dead.

XXV. For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal, but powerful through God for the destruction of strongholds, overthrowing arguments, and every high thing that exalts itself against the knowledge of God; and bringing every thought into captivity to the obedience of Christ. The battle that the saints wage is not coarse or bodily, but subtle and spiritual. They are commended and celebrated not because they wield carnal weapons or skillfully use the points of spears or the throws of projectiles, but rather because, armed with the weapons of truth, they spiritually confront those who seek to adulterate the integrity of divine doctrines and

audaciously distort them to suit their own desires. Therefore, the weapons of the saints are not carnal, but valid in God and for God. For they demolish the fabrications of men that abstract some sense into absurdity; nor do they strive any less to remove these from the midst than certain barbarous ones who openly declare war against royal majesty. And if anyone from that group, who is accustomed to speak iniquity against God, raises his horns on high, he is quickly turned back to the doctrine of truth as if he were a blind man, by those who hold the right faith. Thus, the work of the saints and their industry is truly worthy and will be most pleasing to God, to transfer to the account of divine dispensation those things that seem not to agree sufficiently with the glory of Christ. For when the Word was God and existed in the form and equality of the Father, he humbled himself to the point of emptying himself and became obedient unto death. Therefore, it is necessary to overturn every contrary understanding and to lead it, as if it were captive, into the obedience of Christ. If anything wise is said about human weakness in this regard, it does not at all tarnish the nature of the Word, if we believe that he was made like us as a man. For although he assumed human nature and became obedient according to the flesh even to death, he did not make any loss of his divinity; for God remained as he was.

XXVI. Therefore, holy brothers, as partakers of the heavenly calling, consider the Apostle and High Priest of our confession, Jesus, who is faithful to him who appointed him, just as Moses was faithful in all his house. For this one has been counted worthy of more glory than Moses, inasmuch as he who built the house has more honor than the house itself. For every house is built by someone, but he who built all things is God. And indeed, Moses was faithful in all his house as a servant, for a testimony of those things which were to be spoken afterward; but Christ as a Son over his own house, whose house we are. The Apostle and High Priest of our confession, Jesus, is appointed by God the Father, that is, the Word of God incarnate. For he was called Jesus by the angel. And indeed, the name and office of priesthood and apostleship are very small if attributed to the nature of the Word; however, they are not incongruously adapted to the measure of human nature. For the Son, as he himself testifies elsewhere, did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many. Therefore, whatever he may justly possess by the ministry of all creatures, he has this because he is God, the Lord, and all that has come into being in any way is laid beneath his feet; however, what he ministers belongs to human nature. Nor does this, if you consider the reason for

the dispensation with the flesh, bring dishonor to him who once humbled himself to humanity. See now how according to human nature he fulfills the office of priesthood and stands as a mediator between God and men; for every priest functions in the office of a mediator; however, he does not perform the rite of sacrifice servilely according to the manner of priests of our order, as if he were not the one to whom the sacrifice is offered; rather, he also sacrifices to himself, and through himself, and in himself to God the Father. He offers our confession, that is, our faith; which we are accustomed to express rightly, saying: "We believe in God the Father Almighty; and in one Lord Jesus Christ, his only Son; and in the Holy Spirit." Therefore, although he is said to function as a priest according to human nature, the sacrifice offered is received according to the divine: for the same God is both God and man. He is called faithful because he is always able to save those who come to God through him. Indeed, the Father is also sometimes called faithful. However great the interval may be, the ministry of his humanity exceeds that of Moses, so that if one considers him as God, anyone can easily understand this if he reflects that Moses was indeed a faithful servant in the house; but this one, that is, Emmanuel, presides over the whole house as Lord, indeed, he has been the architect and creator of that house; of which house we are. There is no comparison between created things and the Creator: between him who is by his very nature the Lord and him who is truly a servant and subordinate.

XXVII. "For I descended from heaven, not to do my own will, but the will of him who sent me. And this is the will of him who sent me, the Father, that of all that he has given me, I should lose nothing of it, but should raise it up on the last day." He asserts that he descended from heaven and was sent by God the Father, even if he fulfills all things; he wishes to demonstrate clearly to all, as I believe, that although the Word was God, he humbled himself in a dispensational manner into human nature for our sake. Not that by this he ceased to be God by nature, but that he assumed what was not his own, so that with the body he had taken, which he made his own, opposing death for a time, he would not lose any of those whom he had received, but would preserve them and raise them up from the dead on the last day. However, when he adds that he is to accomplish not his own will, but the will of his Father, he indirectly rebukes the madness of the Jews, who, striving to establish their own will and making light of divine laws, paid no heed to fulfilling the decrees of their Lord. For while he commends his readiness to obey in this place, he does not obscurely accuse their rebellion. Indeed, he also charges them

elsewhere with the fact that they rage against him with hatred, persecution, and unjust judgment by their own design: "You judge according to the flesh; I judge no one; and if I do judge, my judgment is true, for I seek not my own will, but the will of him who sent me." Therefore, he speaks these things according to the dispensation of the flesh.

XXVIII. But come now, let us also consider that other matter. When he descended from heaven as God, he affirms those given to him by the Father, who would believe in him; not to lose them, but to raise them up to life on the last day. But how does he raise them up? Certainly not in any other way than through his own resurrection from the dead. For by restoring his own temple to life, and by demolishing the power of death through the death of his own flesh, he prepared the way for human nature to rise again, as well as to obtain victory against corruption. Therefore, the Word of God, which descended from heaven, is that which made him the firstborn from the dead; by which, indeed, that which was given to him, along with him raised up, may not perish any longer because of the disobedience of the first man, but may obtain salvation and eternal life because of the obedience of Christ. Moreover, as he became man, he speaks of those given to him who receive faith in him. For he possesses all that belongs to the Father by hereditary right. After he had shared in flesh and blood, and we believed in him as in God, it was done so that the name of donation might be attributed to him. For he who ruled before taking on flesh, also, clothed in flesh, obtained a kingdom over us. Thus, as soon as the Word became man, made similar to us, he was inaugurated to hold dominion over us: "The Lord said to me: You are my Son; today I have begotten you." Therefore, although as God he reigns over all, he is said to have received according to human nature, which otherwise belongs to him.

XXIX. It was fitting for him, for whom all things exist and through whom all things exist, who had brought many sons to glory, to perfect the author of their salvation through sufferings. For he who sanctifies and those who are sanctified are all from one source. For this reason, he is not ashamed to call them brothers, saying, "I will proclaim your name to my brothers; in the midst of the congregation, I will praise you" (Hebrews 2:11-12). The more ignorant, who divide our Lord Jesus Christ into two Christs and thus into two sons, perhaps think that the man born of a woman is proclaimed separately by himself, that is, separated from the Word of God the Father, perfected here through sufferings, and that he is called the author of our salvation in this place; however, they assert that

he is perfected and that, as if he were another, he is objectified by the Word itself. For that which is said, "for whom and through whom all things exist," properly pertains to that, which they claim is clearly gathered from the blessed evangelist. For he says, "All things were made through him, and without him was not anything made that was made" (John 1:3). Therefore, it was fitting (as they assert) that the Word of God, through whom all things exist and for whom all things exist, who had brought many sons to glory, should render the author of their salvation (that is, the pure man born of the holy Virgin) perfect and complete through sufferings. However, I will now endeavor to show with as much clarity as possible how their discourse is filled with madness.

XXX. First of all, it is found that this is sometimes expressed through him, even concerning the Father. "Faithful is God," writes blessed Paul, "through whom you were called into the fellowship of his Son." To those, therefore, who had been called through faith to the dignity of freedom, he says: "Therefore you are no longer a servant, but a son; and if a son, then an heir through God." Since divine Scripture uses this phrase indiscriminately and attributes it also to the Father, there is nothing that necessarily compels us to interpret this only concerning the person of the Son. Therefore, since these things are so, why do we not say that the Father made the Son a man through sufferings, understanding this not of the Son but relying on the authority of Scripture and diligently pursuing the discourse congruent with the mystery of the incarnate Only Begotten? For he, willing it so by God the Father, "despising the shame, endured the cross," so that he might also make us, adhering to his footsteps, strong and confident in him who says: "Do not fear those who kill the body, but cannot kill the soul." For he did not wish to break them with fear because they would suffer affliction in the world and persecution from enemies, and would undergo serious struggles for the doctrine of truth, and finally would run the course of virtue not without great sweat and troubles, but rather to animate them through what he himself suffered. To ensure that we would not even shrink from these things, he showed, saying: "A disciple is not above his teacher, nor a servant above his lord; it is enough for the disciple to be like his teacher, and the servant like his lord." "If they have persecuted me, they will also persecute you".

XXXI. Therefore, the purpose set forth for the only-begotten Son of God was to suffer in his flesh for us. The reason for this purpose is explained by the divine Paul in these words: "For the integrity and incorruption of human nature was

lacking, which it had at the beginning of its creation: "For God did not make death, nor does he rejoice in the destruction of the living. For he created all things that they might exist," and the beginnings of the world's salvation are directed toward this end, and in them there is no poison of destruction, nor is there the kingdom of death upon the earth. But through the envy of the devil, death entered the world. Therefore, perfecting us in this manner, he said to the heavenly Father: "I have glorified you on earth; I have finished the work which you gave me to do." For this is indeed the true glory of God the Father, that through his Son he has destroyed death. Through his sufferings, therefore, he himself attained perfection, while for us, the fulfillment of what was lacking was achieved. For through Christ and in Christ, we have become a new creation".

XXXII. That he does not say that a mere and common man is separated from the Word for our sake, but rather that the Only-Begotten himself was given human form, the divine Paul confirms with this statement: "He who sanctifies and those who are sanctified are all from one." For this reason, he is not ashamed to call them brothers, saying, "I will proclaim your name to my brothers." Here it is worth knowing who it is that sanctifies, who those are that are sanctified, and in what way all are from one. The Son sanctifies, being holy by nature, as he is God; we are sanctified by him through the Holy Spirit. But how are all from one? Certainly, all are from one creator and maker, from whom we also necessarily draw mutual brotherhood. For between the begotten and the begotten, inasmuch as they are begotten, there exists a certain natural kinship. Moreover, since the Son is not made by nature, nor can he, as God, enter into any brotherhood with creation, how can it be that all, both those who are sanctified and he who sanctifies, have flowed forth from one? Indeed, for a clear explanation of the proposed matter, we must consider the economy of the incarnation. For when he was made like us according to the flesh, then he too was said to be from one, and was rightly called a brother of creatures, since he assumed human nature. Therefore, for this reason, he was not at all ashamed to call us brothers. For unless he had become like those who were created through him (although by this he did not lose what he was), I do not believe he would have allowed himself to be addressed by the name of brother. Then he too will praise without reproach along with us, whom the Seraphim praise and all creation adores.

XXXIII. And it is manifestly a great sacrament of piety: God was manifested in the flesh, justified in the Spirit, seen by angels, proclaimed among the nations,

believed in the world, and taken up in glory. If God, the Word, does not abandon his divinity but remains steadfast in the goodness in which he was, and is proclaimed as having become man, a truly great mystery of piety is presented here. However, if Christ is merely a common man, joined to God only by a bond of dignity or authority (as some unlearned individuals defend), how was he manifested in the flesh? Is it not clear to all that no one is clothed in flesh who is not human, nor can anyone be seen in any other way? By what reason is he said to have been seen even by the holy angels? Do not angels behold themselves? What, then, is new or unusual or worthy of admiration in Christ, if he bears only the likeness of our nature and is seen by some angels? What kind of being was he proclaimed among the nations? Or what kind of being is he believed to be by those who dwell in the world? For if the disciples preached him to the world as a pure man of our condition, and not as God made man, and he is believed as such by those who live in the world, we shall all be held guilty of the crime of anthropolatry, and we shall be openly convicted of adorning the creature in place of the Creator. And this is due to him who is, by nature and truth, the God of all. For it is evident that he sent teachers to us who would teach these things. If Christ was raised from the dead, the holy apostles declare with these words: "Go therefore and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit"; and we believe in him, and having announced his death and confessed his resurrection, we have been baptized; and by doing this as a custom, we have never been accused of worshiping a mere man: who can doubt that Christ is not merely a pure man honored only by a bare and simple connection with the Word of God; rather, he is one Son and Lord, united in a natural and dispensational union with human nature, and thus a great sacrament of piety has shone forth in the world? For the Word of God appeared in the flesh, was justified in the Spirit (for our Lord designates no sin), was seen by angels, so that those who do not ignore his birth according to the flesh might sing: "Glory to God in the highest, and on earth peace, goodwill toward men"; he was also proclaimed among the nations: indeed, it is believed by those who inhabit this world that he is the true and natural Son of God the Father, who was manifested in the flesh.

XXXIV. And John bore witness, saying: Because I saw the Spirit descending like a dove from heaven, and it remained upon him. And I did not know him, but he who sent me to baptize with water said to me: Upon whom you see the Spirit

descending and remaining upon him, this is he who baptizes with the Holy Spirit. And I have seen, and I bear witness that this is the Son of God. When we assign only one Emmanuel, and do not separate those who divide the one Christ into two, what shall we say when we hear that the Holy Spirit descended from heaven upon him and also remained upon him? Shall we suspect that the Word of God the Father needed the participation of the Holy Spirit? But what could be more absurd than this, either to conceive or to say? For the Spirit is equally proper to him as to God the Father. For you are all children (as blessed Paul says), God has sent the Spirit of his Son into your hearts, crying: Abba, Father. Therefore, it would be impious even to think that the Word of God the Father needed the communication of the Holy Spirit; it would indeed be foolish to inquire into something so plain and evident. But how then did the Holy Spirit descend upon him? For he receives according to human nature, through the dispensation with the flesh, so that he might receive the Spirit without any reproach; indeed, he is necessarily led to this. However, he takes upon himself more truly than for himself: for after he had once departed from men, because their minds had always been inclined to wickedness from youth, now descending in Christ as in a new beginning of our kind, and taking a seat, he again dwells in us as we now rightly act, and live free from sin, and remain untainted by crime in him. However, although as a man he may receive the Holy Spirit for us, as God he is accustomed to impart the same. Upon whom (says he) you see the Spirit descending and remaining, this is he who baptizes with the Holy Spirit. Baptizing in the Holy Spirit is indeed a divine work. Our Lord Jesus Christ infuses the Spirit of the Father as his own into those who are baptized. And this is what the divine Paul aims at when he writes among other things: Those who are in the flesh cannot please God. But you are not in the flesh, but in the Spirit, if indeed the Spirit of God dwells in you. If anyone, therefore, openly testifies that he is the Son of God, John makes it clear.

XXXV. Indeed, I gladly ask those who divide our one Lord Jesus Christ into two sons (for the Father has demonstrated only one; and concerning this one alone, the blessed evangelist has reported, "This is the Son of God"), which of the two should be accepted as the one mentioned? For if the discourse is about the Only-Begotten Word of God the Father taken separately by itself, how did he receive the Spirit, since he is by nature God and possesses the Spirit as his own? But if they say that the man born of a woman was taken separately and by himself through the Holy Spirit, how is it that he is again baptized in the Holy Spirit? Since it is truly the

nature of the most supreme and excellent being to bestow the grace of the Holy Spirit upon those who approach him, it is evident that this arises from the reason of dispensation according to the flesh, and inasmuch as he truly exists by nature as God. Therefore, he receives as a man, not so much for himself as for the whole human race through himself, and in himself first; but from his own power and nature as God, he gives to those who are worthy to receive him. Many other points could also be brought forth in support of this same sentiment, but we have deemed it unnecessary to reiterate the same things frequently, especially since a single explanation may suffice for those who are more ingenious in understanding similar matters. Therefore, whenever Christ is said to be sanctified, that is, to receive the Holy Spirit, it should always be understood in this manner. For it is better to embrace piety while we rightly draw the sense of the sacred Scriptures to proper interpretation than to impiously deny what has been rightly proclaimed concerning the glory of Christ, and thus to go astray.

XXXVI. Jesus, filled with the Holy Spirit, returned from the Jordan and was led by the Spirit into the wilderness for forty days, and he was tempted by the devil. He ate nothing during those days, and when they were completed, he was hungry. It was fitting that he should expose himself to Satan for our sake and snatch away the prey that he had long ago taken, who had lowered himself into voluntary emptiness in order to make us partakers of his fullness; and he would show a certain spiritual strength to those who were once broken and weakened in Adam. For both the bodily and spiritual ailments that were introduced into human nature by the fault of the first man have been removed through Christ. Just as through his obedience many are established as righteous, even if we fall into the sentence of condemnation because of his disobedience, so likewise, through the spiritual strength brought to us by Christ, we are freed from the detriments of ancient diseases; and those who were defeated in Adam have obtained victory in Christ. Therefore, he is presented to the enemy as a man, but he conquers as God. He is tempted again, with Satan insulting him as if he were one of us, and confidently promising that the lusts of the flesh would join forces to bring him down. However, he left in shame when human nature, in a new way in Christ, showed that the law of sin, which had previously raged in the members of the flesh, was extinguished and mortified. For this law has been abolished in Christ. Moreover, when he had fasted sufficiently and preserved his incorruptible flesh by divine power without food and drink, he finally allowed it to feel hunger. He is said to

have been hungry; but for what reason, I ask, does he hunger? It is indeed so that he might fittingly declare himself to be both God and man, one and the same, in that as God he is above us, and in that as man he is recognized as similar to us. Furthermore, he is said to be led into the wilderness by the power of the Spirit, not because being led is the same as being carried, but to lead a life there, or to dwell; just as we sometimes say that someone is conducting themselves well, meaning that they are living an unblemished life. Therefore, he was in the wilderness, that is, he was living there, not in a bodily manner; for without food and drink, which are certainly necessary for human bodies, he dwelled there armed with the power of the Spirit, and he persisted in continuous fasting above the condition of human nature. It should be noted carefully what is presented here; for it contains a certain salubrious teaching. He was not tempted before receiving holy baptism; nor was he led into the wilderness by the Spirit. What, I ask, does this signify for us? It signifies nothing other than that those who have not yet attained the grace of baptism cannot valiantly resist the most serious assaults of the tempter Satan, nor can they begin the way of spiritual life. The time for obtaining such a glorious victory is opportune after holy baptism. For thus, strengthened by participation in the Holy Spirit and confirmed by heavenly grace to spiritual strength, we cannot be caught by the snares of Satan; but as if living in the power of the Spirit, we withdraw into a kind of wilderness, while peacefully passing our lives far from the tumult of this world. Therefore, although it is of little consequence for the omnipotent Word of God to have vanquished Satan, it is nonetheless a great matter for us that through his incarnation we have obtained victory against him; just as it is also significant that through the same incarnation he has restored us to incorruption. For just as through his resurrection we have escaped corruption, so too, through the victory obtained against the tempting Satan, we are made victors.

XXXVII. "Therefore, having a great high priest who has passed through the heavens, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold fast our confession. For we do not have a high priest who cannot sympathize with our weaknesses; but one who has been tempted in all things according to the likeness of our nature, yet without sin. Thus, a confession of right faith is fitting for us, namely that we believe in one God the Father Almighty, and in one Lord Jesus Christ, His Son, and in one Holy Spirit. The divine Paul admonishes us that we ought to adhere to this confession of faith. Since it is certain that there is only one Son of God the Father, namely Christ Jesus, who can sympathize with our weaknesses and who has been tempted in all

things according to the likeness of our nature, who then is this great high priest of ours? Is it not He who truly became like us and suffered in the flesh for us? For then He assumed the title of our high priest; yet not in such a way as to offer an external sacrifice, that is, one alien to Himself, like the priests of others, but He Himself was the lamb, He Himself the most fragrant offering and spiritual holocaust, and He Himself the mourning turtledove and the simple dove; He Himself the living bread and the golden censer. For we are the good odor of Christ to God, as it is revealed in the sacred Scriptures. Moreover, pay careful attention to the depth of the apostolic sentiment here. He says, 'We do not have a high priest who cannot sympathize with our weaknesses, but one who has been tempted in all things according to the likeness of our nature, yet without sin.' Before, he says, the Word of God became man, He had already perfectly explored the weakness of human nature as the Creator of all things. For, as it is written, He knew our formation. However, in truth, in order to know it most fully, He had not yet, I say, experienced our maladies; but after He had put on our flesh, He experienced all things. Yet we do not say that He was entirely ignorant of any of these things before, but that the knowledge He possessed by divine science was also augmented by the knowledge that experience brings. Therefore, the Word of God became one who sympathizes, not because He assumed that sympathy only through temptation or experience (for He was already merciful by His very nature as God), but because, after remaining steadfast in what He was, He also became man like us, and thus what pertains to human nature is rightly affirmed of Him. It is said that He has passed through the heavens (Hebrews 4:14-15). As the most wise Paul notes, He ascended to appear now in the presence of God for us. Indeed, in another sense, He is said to have transcended the heavens, as it is clearly discerned that He left behind the glory of the blessed angels far below Him; since, as God, He is above all principality and power and dominion, and every name that is named not only in this age but also in the age to come. For the Son obtains the same glory and power with His Father, even though He has become like us in the manner of a steward".

XXXVIII. No one takes honor for himself, but only he who is called by God, as was Aaron. Likewise, Christ did not glorify himself to become a high priest, but rather he who spoke to him said, "You are my Son; today I have begotten you" (Psalm 2:7). He who had willingly humbled himself to the point of emptiness awaits the paternal calling that leads to the customary and most fitting function of

the priesthood; this fittingness pertains not to his own nature, but to ours, that is, to human nature, which he fully assumed, taking on what is suitable to him without receiving any detriment according to his own nature, but rather using the dispensation according to the flesh wisely and appropriately. For that which was, namely the Lord, remained according to his nature, even though he had taken on the form of a servant; thus, however many he had in heaven who offered hymns and praises, that is, spiritual and unbloody sacrifices to him, he nonetheless fully preserved what is suitable and congruent to human nature, nor did he disdain the human priesthood. Therefore, he was called as Aaron, yet in a manner that is dissimilar. For Aaron was called to the ministry as a servant; however, Christ was taken according to the order of Melchizedek, as the Son administering to the Father. Moreover, the divine Paul, writing about Christ our Savior, explains the manner of this priestly ministry in this way: "He who was not made according to the law of a carnal command, but according to the power of an indissoluble life" (Hebrews 7:16). Therefore, the rite of that priesthood is incomparably superior to the Aaronic rite. For although he was called to the priesthood, as I have just said, he was a servant; whereas Christ, in that very state, was the Son of God the Father, indeed by nature and eternal generation as God and the Word; but as for our condition, he was a man according to the most recent generation in the flesh, which through that "today," which exists as a mark of the present time, is foreshadowed for us. Therefore, the Father judges that the nativity in the flesh also pertains to himself, inasmuch as he recognizes him as his Son according to the divine nature from himself, and according to human nature from a woman.

XXXIX. He who, in the days of his flesh, offered prayers and supplications to him who could save him from death, with loud cries and tears, was heard because of his reverence. And although he was the Son, he learned obedience from what he suffered; and having been made perfect, he became the source of eternal salvation to all who obey him, being designated by God a high priest according to the order of Melchizedek. The most wise Paul writes to those who have been justified by faith: "Be imitators of me, as I am of Christ." Moreover, the divine Peter also says: "For what credit is it if, when you sin and are beaten for it, you endure? But if when you do good and suffer for it you endure, this is a gracious thing in the sight of God; for to this you have been called, because Christ also suffered for you, leaving you an example, so that you might follow in his steps." Therefore, the aim of the Only Begotten, who took on our likeness, was to suffer according to human

nature and to teach his own family how to confront the assaults of temptations, and what kind of people they should be who suffer persecutions for the sake of divine piety, or who are engaged in any dangers of body and soul; also to set before them the glorious end of obedience, so that we, too, might be found diligent and prudent imitators of those things which he accomplished according to the dispensation of the flesh, and that we might earnestly pursue his footsteps, living a truly approved life. Thus, through those things which he himself, as a man, did and endured for us, he wished to show those who are resolved to endure something adverse for his love that they should maintain a firm and unshaken mind, and that they should value the life that is undertaken for the sake of religion. However, he does not allow those endowed with manly strength to cast aside their souls recklessly, nor to neglect what needs to be done, and merely to wait in vain for what will please the wicked, but rather he encourages them to engage fervently in prayer and to supplicate God without ceasing, teaching this while he offered prayers and supplications to him who could save him from death in the days of his flesh.

XL. Furthermore, consider how this teaching should overflow with the modesty befitting the saints. For to boldly confront temptations is a mark of strength, yet it seems not entirely free from the suspicion of pride; rather, to tremble and appear contracted by fear, and to pour forth prayers to him who can save, is the work of true religion. Otherwise, why did Christ himself command the holy apostles: "When they persecute you in one city, flee to another" (Matthew 10:23)? Why did the most wise Paul, who clearly states, "Who will separate us from the love of Christ? Shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword?" (Romans 8:35), escape from the Damascan authorities by being let down through a window in the wall? Therefore, it was necessary that Christ himself should present himself to us as a leader and teacher for any good work; with a loud cry and supplication, he approached God as a man, as it is written (Acts 9:25). He was also heard as a true and natural Son, who could not suffer rejection. "For I knew," he said, "that you always hear me." In order to render our prayers acceptable to God, he himself was the first to begin the matter, in a way opening and expanding the paternal ears of human nature, making them receptive and prompt to the petitions of those who might one day be in peril for his sake. Thus, we were, as it were, at the very beginning of our kind, who with strong cries and tears earnestly implored that the dominion of death might be abolished in us and that the life once granted to our nature might be firmly restored.

XLI. Furthermore, that the zeal for obeying God is weighed with a splendid reward and results in an illustrious outcome can be learned again from the very same source. For he learned obedience from the things he suffered. This is equivalent to saying: he humbled himself, becoming obedient to the point of death, even death on a cross. Nevertheless, he did not remain in that state of humiliation and lowliness; for he was exalted, receiving a name that is above every name. Indeed, the form of this statement is human; however, an illustrious example is presented to us here, for it is shown that obedience is both glorious and worthy of admiration and a reconciler of all good things. Therefore, Emmanuel did not undergo this before the incarnation, but in the days of his flesh (when, indeed, it was permitted without any mark of injury to his divine glory; rather, when the dispensation with the flesh allowed this: otherwise, how would life have feared death?) he was tempted and assailed, praying with loud cries and tears; we ought to consider this as an example for us to imitate. For since he wishes us to be as courageous as possible in dangers and commands us to disregard the threats of those who kill the body, how could he have been seized by fear? Or how could he have lacked the strength to drive death away from his own flesh, he who removes it from all, who promised that with a mere voice he would raise those who are in the tombs, and in reality demonstrated that he could do so? For calling out to Lazarus, he said, "Come out"; and to the widow's son, "Young man, I say to you, arise"; he immediately brought both back to life.

XLII. But if there are those who, against Scripture, with a certain boldness and perverse understanding, dare to say that he was merely an ordinary man, who, having been born of the holy Virgin, offered prayers and supplications with a loud cry and tears to him who could free him from death, let them consider that they may have heard these words from one of the holy apostles: "These are those who separate themselves, sensual, not having the Spirit." I ask, however, of those who do not blush to utter such things, whether they believe that Emmanuel is entirely a pure man, who is said to have obtained equality in dignity and authority with the Word of God solely because he is joined to him by a certain bond of familial relationship. If they say that he is merely a pure man, entirely similar to us in all respects, they will certainly be held guilty of the open crime of anthropolatry, worshiping him. For it is written: "You shall worship the Lord your God, and him only shall you serve" (Matthew 4:10). If they respond that he has been elevated to equality of dignity and authority with the Word of God, yet they do not thereby

prevent him from approaching the Father with a loud cry and tears, and from being a supplicant to him who can save, nothing at all will hinder the condition of the Word from being considered as great as that of him who has equality of dignity or authority with the Word. Therefore, it will also be fitting for him to shudder at death, to fear danger, to weep in temptations, to need the help of another for salvation, and finally, to learn obedience through explicit temptation. Yet it would be extreme madness to think or say this: for the Word of God is omnipotent, above death, and greater than any human suffering or fear can ever fall upon him. However, although his nature is such, for our sake he endured those passions. Therefore, Christ is neither merely a pure man nor the Word devoid of our flesh, but the Word united to our nature, impassible in himself, yet suffering in his flesh. The things which he endured as a man (as we said a little earlier) are proposed to us as an example, so that we may indeed follow in his footsteps, who, offering himself once, accomplished the whole matter. Indeed, the law established priests subject to infirmity, but the word of the oath, which was given after the law, proclaims that "the Son has been perfected forever by one offering"; that is, by which our Lord Jesus Christ sanctified us through his own body, completing us eternally, since the worship of the ancient law brought no one at all to perfection. Hence, the figures also ceased, and that shadowy imperfection of the Old Testament was taken away. However, a better hope has succeeded, through which we draw near to God, having been introduced into the priestly order by the intervention of Christ, who is indeed necessary.

XLIII. However, when Paul declares that he was crucified out of weakness, how does the law ordain priests bound by weakness, while after the law was promulgated, he affirms the Son as being perfected and completed forever, as if no weakness could fall upon him? For that which is said to be perfect is that which is accumulated with every kind of good. Since he was not such as the priests of the old law, who were not unaccustomed to fall into weaknesses, as it is written, it is evident that they sometimes fell into weaknesses. But how is it that the same one is believed to be greater than weakness, as he is the Son, perfect in every respect, and is taught to be crucified again out of weakness? As he bears the cross according to the flesh, he is rightly proclaimed weak; but as he is God, he is rightly asserted to be superior to any weakness, for the spirit is willing, but the flesh is weak. If there are those who contend that this implies that the legal ministers lived not without sins, I do not oppose this (indeed, I willingly concede to those who wish to think

this way). Therefore, the ministers of the law needed not one but many sacrifices, so that they might offer daily for their own sins as well as for the ignorance of the people, because they continually fell into various weaknesses and were held by that languor which leads to manifold sin. However, he who is greater than one who could sin, as he is God, our high priest, and called a priest according to human nature, offered and consecrated his own body to the Father. According to divine nature, he could not fall into sin, since he was not of created nature, which by itself does not have immutability, nor can it avoid sin entirely, and it does not need any support to bear the fruits of impeccability in its holiness. Therefore, God is entirely through and through the fruit of his own nature, the fruit of impeccability.

XLIV. Now concerning those things which are said: We have such a high priest, who has taken his seat at the right hand of the throne of majesty in the heavens, a minister of the holy places and of the true tabernacle, which the Lord set up, and not man. That old tabernacle was constructed by the most wise Moses in the desert, according to the pattern shown to him on the mountain. Indeed, it was most suitable for the priests of the Old Testament; but the dwelling place fitting for Christ is that heavenly and beautiful city, which is heaven, a truly divine and most exalted tabernacle, not of human invention, but holy and made by God; into which he, having entered, offers those who believe in him, and who have received sanctification through the Spirit, to God the Father. No one, he says, comes to the Father except through me (John 14:6). Therefore, this is the ministry of which we are speaking. And although this matter is expressed in our, that is, human words, it is nevertheless exceedingly divine. Is it not, I beseech you, something divine, that believers can sanctify by their own Spirit; and that, justified by mercy and grace, they can offer themselves, dead to the world, vivified by the Spirit, conspicuous to God in their life and moral integrity, and as it were consecrate themselves? That although he is said to minister, he is neither less than the Father, nor does he yield in any part to his glory, can be clearly established from the fact that he holds the throne of divine majesty and sits at the right hand of the Father. For if it is true that every priest stands to offer a sacrifice, it cannot be understood that he sits or shares in any way in the same glory with God, to whom he offers the sacrifice: how then does Christ exercise a new kind of priesthood, who ministers as a man, yet sits in the throne of divinity? If anyone, wickedly opposing the truth, contends that a man, according to the mere equality of dignity, is joined to God and sits at the right hand of the Father, he certainly asserts that the supreme throne is no longer solely

that of the holy Trinity, nor fitting only for him alone. But now a fourth God, newly introduced and made, is presented to us, besides the consubstantial and holy Trinity.

XLV. Christ, however, being the high priest of future goods, entered through a greater and more perfect tabernacle, not made by human hands, that is, not of this creation; nor by the blood of goats and calves, but by his own blood he entered once into the holy place, having obtained eternal redemption. By this reasoning, our Lord Jesus Christ, having entered through the greater and more perfect tabernacle, has indeed become our high priest, as the words just recited make clear to us. That he has surpassed the legal priesthood in the ritual of that priesthood and has greatly excelled those things which were contained only in shadow and figure (for he himself was the true and unblemished victim) is something that, I believe, no one will deny. Observe here, however, that glorious and admirable High Priest of ours, who sits at the right hand of the throne of the majesty of God in the heavens, having entered once into the holy place by his own blood, and having found eternal redemption. But how can he, who as God sits at the right hand of God the Father, rightly be said to have his own blood, if he is indeed the natural Son of God and also the Son of man, and has offered his own blood as the price for all, thereby securing eternal salvation for the world? I have not been fully convinced of this. For no one would say that it was necessary for him to be sacrificed repeatedly like some animal; indeed, it was sufficient for him to have undergone death once for the liberation of the whole world. But if, as some believe, he was purely a man by nature, joined to God in dignity or authority, yet separated from him according to hypostasis and placed apart by himself, then certainly the blood that was shed for the redemption of the world was not that of the one who sits at the right hand of God the Father, but of another who has rather a relative connection with him. Just as two princes, fully endowed with the same authority, are indeed two men, so it does not allow for one to be equal in dignity while being distinct in nature, namely, in separate persons; thus, the blood of one is indeed that of this one, in such a way that it cannot be that of another. Therefore, for true unity, it is not sufficient to assert that a man is joined to God in equality of authority or dignity.

XLVI. For Christ did not enter into a holy place made by hands, nor into copies of the true, but into heaven itself, so that he might now appear in the presence of God for us. "Heaven," says God, "is my throne"; therefore we also say that the Son rests

above the heavenly spirits and possesses heaven as a certain holy tabernacle, not in the manner of earthly ministers, who serve in a corporeal way with sacred rites and offer blood according to the prescriptions of the law for the expression of the true. But how, I ask, does he now appear in the presence of God for us? Was he not always present and manifest even before the incarnation? This is easy to understand, for he is the artisan, the wisdom of God and the Father, through whom all things were brought into being. And certainly, as Wisdom says, "I was beside him as a master craftsman, and I was daily his delight, rejoicing always before him, rejoicing in his inhabited world, and delighting in the children of men" (Proverbs 8:30-31). Therefore, when from the beginning the Father delighted in him and took pleasure in him daily, and he in turn brought joy to the Father, how is it that he is said to appear in the presence of God now? Indeed, the Word of God appears anew, no longer stripped and bare as in the beginning, but in the form and nature of a human being. Thus, he is said to appear for us and to offer human nature (even though it was once hated and rejected because of Adam's transgression) in the presence of God the Father. Therefore, the Word, having become man, presents us before the Father's eyes as if in himself; in this way, he commends us to the Father, having been cleansed from ancient sins and restored to newness of life through the Spirit, and finally made worthy to be received as sons in the presence of the Father.

XLVII. The Apostle Paul was not sent by men, nor through men, but through Jesus Christ and God the Father who raised him from the dead. To demonstrate that our Lord Jesus Christ did not receive glory from external appearances, it was sufficient to indicate that he sent ministers just as God the Father did, who preached him; for those who were sent did not preach themselves, but Jesus Christ for the glory of God the Father. Since we are to follow the sacred Scriptures, we must not deviate in the slightest from their decrees; therefore, let us clarify briefly how God the Father is said to have crowned his Son with glory. Blessed Paul writes in one place about the rulers of this world: "For if they had known, they would not have crucified the Lord of glory" (1 Corinthians 2:8). He knew, therefore, that he who suffered the punishment of the cross was the Lord of glory. Now, how does the Lord of glory receive glory from the Father? The resolution to this question is found in the nature of the dispensation. He receives glory as a man; however, he continues to be the Lord of glory as God. Indeed, the riches of that divine nature are evident to us from those prerogatives that surpass the capacity of creation;

however, the condition of human poverty is made clear to us by the fact that certain things are said to have been received: “For you know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that though he was rich, yet for your sake he became poor” (2 Corinthians 8:9). Therefore, our thoughts ought to strive to understand him in such a way that, while we recognize him as God, we never consider him to have been wealthy, establishing our beliefs according to the norm of right faith, and affirming that he has truly lowered himself to our poverty, so that we may be convinced of this.

XLVIII. The Father loves the Son, and has given all things into his hands. The Son receives as a man; meanwhile, the Father does not exclude himself from any of these things, but holds all things in his power. For by giving to the Son, he reigns over all things together with him. But also the very race of mortals, some of whom are unbridled and inclined to rebellion, submits itself to the scepters of divinity through him; since, as the wise Paul admonishes us somewhere, God was in Christ, reconciling the world to himself. Here, however, we do not assert, as some unrefined individuals do, that another Christ inhabited the man whom the sacred Virgin brought forth, and reconciled the world to himself; but rather that the very God the Father reconciled the world to himself in Christ. For the Son, after human nature was assumed, became the mediator and in a certain way the reconciler for obtaining peace, not conciliating obedience to someone else in the world, but rather in his own person to God the Father; since through Christ reconciled, we are also reconciled to God, the Savior of all, through him and in him. Hence that saying: Come to me, all you who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest. That those who join themselves to him are reconciled to no one other than the true and natural God, he makes clear with these very words. He says, He who believes in me does not believe in me, but in him who sent me. And he who sees me sees him who sent me. And again: Believe in God, and believe also in me.

XLIX. Father, the hour has come; glorify your Son, that your Son may glorify you. As you have given him authority over all flesh, so that he may give eternal life to all whom you have given him. He is called the Advocate and the Propitiator. He indeed makes the heavenly Father gracious and favorable to men, and for this reason, he is the author of all good things for us. However, it is worthy of inquiry by what reason the Father glorifies the Son and the Son in turn glorifies the Father. He says, therefore, that the hour has come, that is, the time in which he must undergo the punishment of the cross for the life of the world. It was fitting,

however, that the Father should glorify the Son through the resurrection from the dead, and that he should demonstrate by evident testimony that he has taken on a nature consubstantial with himself, life-giving, superior to death, and free from corruption. Indeed, the Father is glorified in this very fact, that he has a Son who is in all things similar to him in beauty, glory, and power. This is clearly shown by the Son when, having demolished the power of death, he raised his own temple from the dead. However, although he is said to have received authority and power over all as a man, as God he absolutely reigns over all natures of things. The Father again grants eternal life to those who have been given to the Son; but he, in the meantime, is that very life itself. I am, he says, the resurrection and the life. Therefore, although he is said to have received glory and a kingdom, and power over all and everything, this must be referred to the condition of the incarnation. It is certain, indeed, that the Son, as God, is the Lord of glory and is endowed with the same majesty as the Father; nor, in regard to the nature of divinity, is the glory and eminence of the Father in any way inferior. In this manner, therefore, let us be pious and convert all understanding to the obedience of Christ, and let us bring down every thought that exalts itself against the knowledge of God.

L. Therefore, having been exalted at the right hand of God and receiving the promise of the Holy Spirit from the Father, he poured out what you see and hear. For David did not ascend into heaven; rather, he himself says, "The Lord said to my Lord: Sit at my right hand until I make your enemies a footstool for your feet" (Psalm 110:1). From this, one can clearly perceive the entire mystery of the incarnate Word. Indeed, that omnipotent right hand, the hand of the Creator of all, while the Word of God was in the form and equality of the Father, was emptied for the sake of human nature and is proclaimed as exalted; not because he was raised to an alien glory, that is, to one which he could not naturally possess before, but because he returned to his own glory, which is naturally inherent and begotten within him. Thus, having become this way, he was exalted according to human nature, although according to his nature he is always the Most High. And I believe this to be the manner of nature, which we call emptying. Therefore, God became man, and although what was seen was merely a pure man, he was nonetheless proclaimed among the nations; he was believed in the world, honored as the true Son of God the Father, and finally adorned with the highest glory and dignity, as he was believed to be God. Nor is this matter unusual for him. For we recognize true humility in human nature and true sublimity in exaltation, even though his

own glory shone forth. Since indeed all things in heaven and from God come to human nature and human condition, therefore the Son, although he is according to himself the right hand and the Creator of all, is justly and rightly said to be exalted at the right hand of the Father. Observe here again that our Lord Jesus Christ, according to his human nature, receives the Spirit, while according to his divine nature he fulfills the promise of the Father by sending the Holy Spirit, not as something alien to himself, but as something proper to him, to the faithful. For God, through one of the holy prophets, somewhere says, "I will pour out my Spirit upon all flesh" (Joel 2:28). However, Christ the Lord grants this promise when he sends the Spirit as his own to those called to faith. And it is not fitting for anyone to impart the Holy Spirit to man at will, but only to the true and natural God. Therefore, when the Son imparted the Holy Spirit, which belongs to God and the Father, he accomplished this. It is thus a human thing to receive the Spirit; however, it is divine and above man to pour out the Holy Spirit from one's own fullness into others. Therefore, the Word, which appeared in human form, is God, whence it follows that he also shares in majesty with the Father.

LI. The divine Paul writes about the patriarch Abraham: "It is not written for him alone, that it was credited to him as righteousness; but also for us, to whom it will be credited, who believe in him who raised Jesus our Lord from the dead; who was delivered up for our transgressions and raised for our justification" (Romans 4:23-25). Indeed, one divine essence is worshipped in three persons, both by us and also by those heavenly spirits. However, since there exists only one divinity, it is fitting that the whole work is considered, whatever can proceed from that one. For God the Father works all things through the Son in the Holy Spirit. Therefore, if the Father is said to give life, it is understood that he does this entirely through the Son in the Holy Spirit. Again, if the Son is proclaimed to give life to those who are without life, it cannot be thought that he does this without the cooperation of the coessential Father, so that he may always have in himself the one who begot him: "I do not speak of myself," he says plainly, "but the Father who dwells in me does his works" (John 14:10). Finally, if the Spirit operates this, he operates it as the Spirit of life. Now we say that God the Father and the Son, who is begotten from him, are life according to nature. Although the Father is said to have raised Christ from the dead, we will find that the Son was not idle concerning the resurrection of his own body, for he is recorded as having spoken to the Jews in this way: "Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up" (John 2:19).

Thus, when blessed Paul teaches that "it will also be credited to us for righteousness, who believe in him who raised Jesus Christ from the dead," we have believed not only in God the Father but also in our Lord Jesus Christ. Moreover, I think it is worth noting here that the Only-Begotten, having become man, indeed suffered death according to the flesh, yet he did not rise again by the power of the flesh, that is, of humanity, but by the virtue of divinity, which gives life to the dead and calls those things that are not as though they were (Romans 4:17). Therefore, this "giving life" is not attributed to the very nature of the body, although it has been properly derived from the Word begotten of God, but rather it should be referred to that supreme virtue, that is, to that nature which justly exceeds all creation, as in the person of God the Father, from whom the Son proceeds, being in all things equal and consubstantial with him, and also the life-giving Spirit proceeds through both. Furthermore, it is added that Christ was delivered up for our transgressions; however, he was raised for our justification. For just as it happened that he suffered death in his own flesh for our sake, so that the power of death might be dissolved in the future, in the same way he rose again for our sake, showing us the way to immortality, having abolished the sins of Adam's transgression. For we are justified through Christ, demolishing the power of that ancient curse through perfect obedience in every way, liberating human nature from ancient crimes. For sin was, even if in the beginning, that is, in Adam, as we have previously mentioned, subject to condemnation; it admitted no fault, but was worthy of all praise, even if in the beginning, that is, in Adam, as we have previously mentioned, it was subject to condemnation.

LII. Do you not know that we who were baptized into Christ Jesus were baptized into his death? For we were buried with him through baptism into death, so that just as Christ was raised from the dead by the glory of the Father, we too might walk in newness of life. Our Lord Jesus Christ, having stripped hell and freed the multitude of spirits that were held in the subterranean prisons, rose again on the third day, and, having come back to life, said to the holy apostles: "Go therefore and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit." Therefore, just as we are baptized in the one name of the Father, so we are also baptized in the one name of the Son, and we are cleansed by his death and the Holy Spirit. Those who divide our one Lord Jesus Christ into two sons, claiming that he is united to God only according to the equality of dignity or authority, while the natures and persons remain distinct, let

them teach us into whose death we have been baptized. For if they say we are baptized into the death of the divine Word, as conceived separately in his own mind, we would attribute corruption to the incorruptible nature, and we would ascribe death to him who is life by his very nature. But if they respond that we are cleansed in the death of him who is understood to have been born separately and by himself from the holy Virgin, how can they fail to profess clearly that he is entirely the one who shares the same order and dignity with the Father and the Holy Spirit? Perhaps they even strip him of true sonship, born of the Word of God, if he is capable of death into which we have been baptized. But who, I ask, with a sound mind, does not notice the manifest absurdity of this doctrine? Therefore, it must necessarily be established that the Word of God became like us and voluntarily underwent death in the flesh. For this reason, we are baptized into his death, since there is only one Son, who according to the nature of divinity could suffer nothing, but according to humanity could. Finally, that Christ transforms us into the newness of life through his resurrection is not in question. For he presents us as living from the dead to himself and to the Father. For it is written: "We were indeed dead to sin, but alive to righteousness".

LIII. But if his Spirit who raised Jesus Christ from the dead dwells in you, he who raised Jesus Christ from the dead will also give life to your mortal bodies through his Spirit who dwells in you. Although the only-begotten Word of God is life according to his divine nature, nonetheless, having taken on a body subject to death, he tasted death by the grace of God for everyone; however, by divine power he returned to life, for it was impossible for death to hold him. For these reasons, he is said to have been raised from the dead by the Father. Now, let us carefully consider how the Father also proclaims that our mortal bodies will be vivified by his Spirit who dwells in us. Therefore, he will give life, and there is no doubt about the truth of this matter; moreover, that very vivifying Spirit is also the Spirit of Christ. For it is written: "You are not in the flesh, but in the Spirit, if indeed the Spirit of God dwells in you." But if anyone does not have the Spirit of Christ, he does not belong to him. And again, it is written concerning the holy apostles: "When they had come to Mysia, they attempted to go into Bithynia, but the Spirit of Jesus did not permit them." Since therefore his Spirit, who raised him, is proper to him, although God the Father is said to vivify us in the Spirit, who can doubt that the resurrection has occurred in such a way that it was accomplished by the Word of God together with the Father, from whom it naturally proceeds, and

whose vivifying Spirit also exists prior?

LIV. You seek an experience of him who speaks in me, Christ: who is weak in us, but powerful in you? For although he was crucified in weakness, yet he lives by the power of God. For we also are weak in him, but we will live with him by the power of God in you. Some of those who believed, having suffered offense concerning our Lord Jesus Christ from certain sayings, had fallen into such thoughts: If he was the true God and the natural Son of the omnipotent God, why did he not escape the hands of murderers? For by enduring the most disgraceful death on the cross, it cannot be understood how he was both God and yet succumbed to the hands of those who crucified him, and how he was bound by our weaknesses. To such thoughts, blessed Paul responds: If you will seriously consider in your hearts who and what kind of one it is who speaks in me, and if you diligently reflect on those things that pertain to us, you will find a suitable solution to this knot. For he was not weak in us, but through his powerful Spirit, he shows strength and effectiveness; such that without any difficulty, he is able to repel the assaults of any temptations that rush upon us, and to stand boldly against all the onslaughts of afflictions. What then? someone might say, O Paul, was it not a sign of weakness to bear the cross? Did this indeed serve as an argument of virtue? Or of divinity? Not at all, he says. For I acknowledge that he was weakened in the flesh, but he rose again by divine power; for he was God by nature. Why then, or how was he weakened? He allowed his own body to taste death for our sake, in order that through death he might destroy him who had the power of death, that is, the devil, and free those who through fear of death were subject to lifelong slavery. Therefore, since a slight weakness according to the flesh existed for the sake of salvation for those under heaven, how would it not have been entirely fitting for him to undergo that weakness, by which he would destroy death? By vivifying his own temple again, he is a wonder to all, not performing this through the weakness of the flesh, but through divine power: for it is the power of the Father, and the resurrection and the life. Thus he lives forever; for he is life. Nor is there any doubt that we too shall one day partake of life with him, who now, together with him, are burdened by weakness in undergoing death, although we are sustained by the certain hope of eternity. For he rose from the dead, clearing the way for our nature to life; for he was called the firstborn from the dead, and the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep.

LV. Now my soul is troubled. And what shall I say? Father, save me from this hour. But for this purpose, I came to this hour. Father, glorify your Son. And in another place again: And he began to be troubled and distressed, and he said: My soul is very sorrowful, even to death. And again: And crying out with a loud voice, Jesus said: Father, into your hands I commend my spirit. Those who follow the opinion of Apollinaris and subscribe to the same sentiment contend that the temple was united to God, devoid of soul and reason; but what can they possibly respond when they read that the holy evangelists have recorded such things about our Savior? For whose sorrow, I ask, or of all those things that indicate fear, could that supreme and divine nature of the Word ever be capable? For it is greater than any such things could affect or be moved by any human perturbations at all. However, in a body devoid of sense and understanding, it cannot fall into the pains of sorrow; nor can it ever conceive any heaviness or grief from the foreknowledge of impending troubles; but while it reflects on what is present and still to come, the soul, composed of reason and intelligence, is accustomed to suffer: this is something that all, I believe, acknowledge. How then does Emmanuel say: Now my soul is troubled? How does he express that he is distressed and sorrowful, or what kind of spirit did he commend into the hands of the Father, if this is entirely alien to divinity and solely devoid of soul? It is evident, therefore, that the Only-Begotten, having assumed a body, was not indeed devoid of soul or lacking in mind, but rather possessed a soul endowed with reason, and that same soul was perfect, that is, having all that pertains to its reason, having become a man vivified and informed. And just as he ascribes to himself all that belongs to his body, so too does he ascribe what pertains to the soul. For it was necessary that in all things, whether they pertain to the soul or to the body, he should be made like us. We too are composed of a rational soul and a body. Therefore, just as he sometimes permitted his own flesh to suffer what is proper to the flesh, so he also permitted his soul to suffer. Finally, although he was God by nature and superior to all creation, he always accurately observed those things that were of the human condition. Moreover, he commends his spirit, that is, the soul united to himself, to God the Father, so that through this new benefit he may enrich us. For once, human souls, stripped of their bodies, were cast down to subterranean prisons, destined to be filled with death; but after Christ commended his spirit into the hands of the Father, he also opened this way for us. For now we do not descend with our souls entrusted to him as a faithful Creator; rather, he will ultimately recall us to life.

LVI. Just as the living Father sent me, and I live because of the Father, so whoever eats me will also live because of me. I would gladly question those in hell about this, but let us follow our leader; for as long as we live in good hope, we await Christ, who reconciles all. Those who divide the one Christ into two ask whether he is the one sent by God the Father, who lives because of the Father, and for this reason exists as life. For if they claim that his Word exists in isolation, how, I ask, is it eaten by us so that we may live through it? For divinity, by its very nature, is entirely devoid of a body. If, however, they assert that only a man was conceived separately and sent, how does he possess the power of life, since he derives life from the Father? Do not all of us who dwell on earth live by God and the Father, who gives us life? Is it not true that in him we live, move, and exist (Acts 17:28)? Therefore, since we all live through the Father, how is it that only the body of one man is proclaimed to live for this reason? Why are our own bodies not endowed with that power, since, as I said, we live and exist through the Father? What then shall we say to these things? The Word of God, when it appeared in human form, was an apostle, that is, sent. For he was sent to proclaim release to the captives and recovery of sight to the blind (Luke 4:18). He lives because of the Father, for he was begotten from the living Father. It was necessary in every way for him to have life according to nature, who was born from the living and life-giving God the Father. And since he took a body from the holy Virgin, he made it living, and indeed very fittingly so. For it is the body of the one who gives life to all. Therefore, it is not permissible to divide the one Son, Christ, and Lord into two sons; for he himself is life, since he was born from the living and life-giving Father, and through his own body he is again life-giving, as he became God and man like us.

LVII. Just as the Father has life in himself, so he has granted the Son to have life in himself; and he has given him authority to execute judgment, because he is the Son of Man. But how, someone might ask, does the Father have life in himself? Is it received from elsewhere or given by another? Certainly not. To teach or to think this would be nothing other than open madness. Indeed, what could it be but a manifest blasphemy against that ineffable nature? For if the life he possesses were different from himself, the God of all would not be a certain simple nature, but a composite one. Moreover, if it were asserted that he received life from elsewhere, the one who imparts life to another who does not have it would, without any controversy, be greater in many respects and more abundant in all good things.

Therefore, to believe that this is the case is to imagine God the Father as having life from elsewhere, as if he were obtaining it from an external source; this would be nothing other than the most absurd delirium. Thus, the Father has life in himself, not as something added or adventitious, but rather naturally, as a substantial fruit existing in himself. In the same way, he has also granted the Son to have life in himself. And how can the Son, having received life from the Father, possess it substantially within himself? This, I believe, someone might say. Therefore, the Son also has life in himself, since he is from the Father according to nature, as life in himself, as God is; and indeed, he is said to have received it along with the power to judge, even though he exists as the judge of all. Furthermore, the reason for this reception is indicated when it is added: because he is the Son of Man. For it is not proper for a man to be able to have life from himself; but because the body has been made living by the Word, it is fittingly said to have received life, as having the action of the living Word. The reality itself is transferred into him, whose own it is that body which has received life.

LVIII. Our Lord Jesus Christ says somewhere: "But when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?" (Luke 18:8). Therefore, as we ponder the meaning of these words, let us consider what kind of faith our Lord Jesus Christ will require upon his return from heaven. For if he wishes to be believed by us without any other evidence than that of a mere man, I do not think that either God or the true Son of God would doubt that he would find faith more readily among pagans and Jews than among us. Indeed, the idolaters and others who venerate created things in place of the Creator, upon hearing of the cross and the death that he endured for our sake, immediately burst into insane laughter; and if anyone were to name God, they would indignantly recoil and define this as anthropolatry. The Jews, rising up against Christ, will not hesitate to openly object: "We do not stone you for a good work, but for blasphemy, because you, being a man, make yourself God" (John 10:33). Therefore, since he will not demand a faith like that of the erring, but rather the faith that we hold, who are accustomed to think rightly, we must necessarily confess that he who became the Son of Man for our sake is indeed God by nature, lest we, by ignorance, be charged with the same errors as those who err, and thus be found to hold certain vile opinions about Christ just as they do.

LIX. For the Father, Christ says again, does not judge anyone, but has given all judgment to the Son; so that all may honor the Son just as they honor the Father. And again, as we were saying: "For just as the Father has life in himself, so he has

granted the Son to have life in himself; and he has given him authority to execute judgment, because he is the Son of Man." Blessed David also says somewhere: "For God is a judge." Moreover, some of Christ's disciples also write that there is one judge and one lawgiver. Therefore, the authority to judge can belong to no one else but to him alone who is the Lord of all, that is, to God. How then did he entrust judgment to the Son of Man? For if he has given him that authority, as if he were one of us, how will he be truthful when he says: "I will not give my glory to another"? For it pertains to the glory of God to exercise judgment. But if he has communicated judicial authority to the Son in such a way that he himself, because of the identity of substance, has not lost the right to judge, and yet he who has received it is the Son of Man, how is it not evident to all that the Word, because of that ineffable generation from God the Father, is God; and likewise, because he is united to flesh, born of a woman, is the Son of Man? Therefore, when he says to the Jews: "Why do you seek to kill me, a man who has spoken the truth to you?" and again: "No one ascends into heaven except he who descended from heaven, the Son of Man"; and again: "And just as Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness, so must the Son of Man be lifted up"; or when he speaks of himself in this way: "For the Son of Man is going to come in the glory of his Father with his angels"; and again: "Who do men say that I, the Son of Man, am?" Finally, to conclude with a single word, whenever in the divinely inspired Scripture a man is referred to, we do not conceive of him as a man apart from the Word that is from God, but rather we believe that the Word of God has become the Son of Man for our sake, without any loss or detriment to his divinity, and that he is one Lord, our Jesus Christ. Therefore, it cannot be joined with the utmost impiety, after that indivisible and inseparable union which far exceeds all understanding of mind and reason, if anyone divides one into two Christs or two sons. Moreover, if anyone were inclined to examine all that is recorded about Christ in writing more diligently, it would certainly not be too difficult for him to add many other statements to these; but we know it is written: "Give the wise man an opportunity, and he will become wiser." May God, the Lord of all, direct your minds, most religious empresses, through the Holy Spirit, so that you may attain right understanding. Indeed, Christ the Lord, finding you thus prepared, that is, adorned with firm and stable faith, will enrich you abundantly with heavenly goods and will make you exceedingly blessed. For all our hope is placed in Christ; through whom and with whom be glory to the Father with the Holy Spirit, forever and ever. Amen.